INCH-POUND

MIL-C-46397C (AR)
AMENDMENT 3
12 September 1996
SUPERSEDING
AMENDMENT 2
11 May 1992

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CARTRIDGE, 5.56MM, REFERENCE

This amendment forms a part of MIL-C-46397C (AR), dated 30 August 1985, and is approved for use by the US Army Armaments, Research, Development and Engineering Center, and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

PAGE 2

2.1.2 Delete: "10523634" and substitute "10535857"

Delete:

"10535858 - Packaging and Marking,Cartridges, 5.56mm, Cartons, Box, Ammunition, M2A1, Box, Wirebound"

Substitute:

"12551963 - Packing and Marking for Box Wirebound for Cartridge, 5.56mm".

PAGE 3

3.5 Delete: "shall be 3250 feet per second" and substitute "shall be 3165 feet per second".

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PAGE 4

4.3.1.2 Delete in its entirety and substitute the following:

"Component parts. Unless otherwise specified, component parts shall be homogeneous and of a quantity convenient to the contractor, and inspected, tested and accepted by the contractor. The cartridge lot shall contain:

a. Cartridge cases from one unchanged process and one manufacturer.

b. Bullets from one unchanged process and from one manufacturer.

c. Primers from one lot and one manufacturer.

d. Propellant from one lot and one manufacturer.

PAGE 10

4.3.3, Line 4 Delete "4.3" and substitute "4.4".

4.3.3 a, Line 6 Delete "Sufficient cartridges shall be selected such that all testing (including testing of second samples where applicable) can be performed".

PAGE 11

4.3.3.1 Bullet extraction, under PARAGRAPH REFERENCE/INSPECTION METHOD column, delete: "4.3.1" and substitute "4.4.1".
Residual stress, under PARAGRAPH REFERENCE/INSPECTION METHOD column, delete: "4.3.2" and substitute "4.4.2".
* Waterproofness, under PARAGRAPH REFERENCE/INSPECTION METHOD column, delete "4.3.4" and substitute "4.4.4".
Velocity, under PARAGRAPH REFERENCE/ INSPECTION METHOD column, delete: "4.3.4" and substitute "4.4.4".
Chamber pressure, under PARAGRAPH REFERENCE/INSPECTION METHOD column, delete: "4.3.5" and substitute "4.4.5".
Port pressure, under PARAGRAPH REFERENCE/INSPECTION METHOD column, delete: "4.3.6" and substitute "4.4.6".
Function and casualty, under NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS, delete: "600" and substitute "300". Under PARAGRAPH REFERENCE/ INSPECTION METHOD column, delete: "4.3.7" and substitute "4.4.7".
Head, under AQL or 100% column, delete: "3/" and substitute "6/".

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Sidewall, under AQL or 100% column, delete: "1/" and substitute "7/". Under PARAGRAPH REFERENCE/INSPECTION METHOD column, delete: "4.3.8.2" and substitute "4.4.8.2".

PAGE 12

4.3.3.1, 5/, Delete: "Table III" and substitute "Table I".

6/, Delete in its entirety and substitute the following:

"6/ Failure of one or more cartridges to comply with the applicable requirement shall be cause for rejection of the lot. No second sample permitted."

Add the following note after note 6/:

"7/ Failure of one or more cartridges to comply with the applicable requirement shall be cause for rejection of the lot subject to testing of a second sample consisting of double the quantity of cartridges used in the first test. Failure of one or more of the cartridges in the second sample to comply with the applicable requirement shall be cause for rejection of the lot."

PAGE 13

4.3.3.1, Table I, Delete in its entirety and substitute:

TABLE I

Firing defect classification and accept-reject criteria

Defect Class	Defect Description	ACC	REJ
	CARTRIDGE FAILURES		
Critical	a. Bullet in bore	0	1
Critical	b. Misfire - vent hole missing or blocked 1/	0	1
Major	c. Misfire - (excluding b. above)	0	1
	PRIMER FAILURES		
Major	a. Perforation of firing pin indent in primer cup	0	1
Major	b. Escape of gas through primer	0	1

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	cup (excluding a. above)		
Major	c. Loose primer 2/	1	2
Major	d. Blown primer 2/	0	1
Major	e. Dropped primer 2/	0	1
	f. Escape of gas around primer cup		
Major	(1) 50% or more than 50% of periphery	3	4
Minor	(2) Less than 50% of periphery	5	6
	CASE CASUALTIES 3/		
I. Longitudinal split			
Major	a. Body (J)	1	2
Major	b. Body (K)	0	1
Major	c. To head (L)	0	1
Major	d. Through head (M)	0	1
Major	e. Neck and shoulder(I or S)	5	6
II. Circumferential rupture			
Major	a. Partial shoulder or body (J & S)	0	1
Major	b. Partial, body (K)	0	1
Major	c. Partial, head (L)	0	1
Major	d. complete	0	1

Note 1/ Each cartridge that misfires shall be disassembled and examined for a blocked or absent vent hole. If the vent hole is blocked or missing, the lot shall be rejected.

Note 2/ Primer defect description:

a. loose primer The fired primer shall be called loose when it protrudes above the case head or movement of the primer can be observed by applying pressure on the primer by means of a probe, thumbnail or fingertip.

b. Blown primer A primer which, when the cartridge is fired, is separated completely from the head of the cartridge case, and both the head of the case and the primer pocket are grossly distorted and deformed. The severity of this condition is such that it is readily detectable with the naked eye.

c. Dropped primer A primer which falls from the primer pocket after the cartridge is fired.

Note 3/ For location of defects indicated by letters in parenthesis, see drawing 7643674.

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4.2.4 Delete: paragraph number "4.2.4" and substitute "4.3.4".

PAGE 15

4.2.5 Delete: paragraph number "4.2.5" and substitute "4.3.5".

4.2.5.1 Delete: paragraph number "4.2.5.1" and substitute "4.3.5.1". Delete: "specified in 4.3" and substitute "specified in 4.4".

4.3 Delete: paragraph number "4.3" and substitute "4.4.1".

4.3.1 Delete: paragraph number "4.3.1" and substitute "4.4.1".

4.3.2 Delete: paragraph number "4.3.2" and substitute "4.4.2".

4.3.3 Delete: paragraph number "4.3.3" and substitute "4.4.3".

4.3.4 Delete: paragraph number "4.3.4" and substitute "4.4.4".

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4.3.5 Delete: paragraph number "4.3.5" and substitute "4.4.5".

4.3.6 Delete: paragraph number "4.3.6" and substitute "4.4.6".

4.3.7 Delete: paragraph number "4.3.7" and substitute "4.4.7".

4.3.8 Delete: paragraph number "4.3.8" and substitute "4.4.8".

4.3.8.1 Delete in its entirety and substitute the following:

"4.4.8.1 Case head. The individual hardness value for each prescribed point in the head section of each sample case shall be recorded. Any value failing to meet the drawing requirement at a prescribed point(s) shall be cause for remeasurement of hardness at the corresponding point(s) on the opposite side of the primer pocket of same head section from which the initial value was obtained. The higher of the two measurements shall be recorded as the value of record for determination of conformance to the drawing requirements."

4.3.8.2 Delete: paragraph number "4.3.8.2" and substitute "4.4.8.2".

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4.3.9 Change paragraph number from "4.3.9" to "4.4.9".

5.1 Delete: "10523634" and substitute "10535857".

5.2 Delete: "10523635" and substitute "12551963".

5.3 Delete: "10523635" and substitute "12551963".

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